

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

How Do Climate Scientists Make Predictions?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	Supercomputers receive large amounts of physical and _____ data.
2	The processed data produce pictures of _____ on Earth.
3	Models make _____, rather than fixed predictions.
4	Each projection's _____ on other factors means its outcome is not fixed.
5	The main human influence is _____.
6	Clouds have a _____ on the planet.
7	They cool the Earth by _____.
8	They also warm it through their own _____.
9	Because clouds move and change constantly, they are _____.
10	Since humans created the warming problem, people still have _____ over its solution.

11 **What is the central point about the results produced by climate models?**

- A They calculate one exact temperature that the Earth will reach.
- B They present conditional future scenarios rather than guaranteed outcomes.
- C They mainly reconstruct past climate conditions from historical records.
- D They remove the need to consider future human behaviour.

12 **What role do supercomputers play in the modelling process?**

- A They compare incoming sunlight with radiation leaving the Earth.
- B They track only the movement of clouds around the world.
- C They decide which climate policies people should follow.
- D They process scientific data to create pictures of possible futures.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

- 13 **How does a projection differ from a prediction in the discussion?**
- A A projection links an outcome to a condition, while a prediction states what is expected to happen.
 - B A projection describes past events, while a prediction describes present conditions.
 - C A projection gives a certain result, while a prediction depends on future choices.
 - D A projection uses chemical data, while a prediction uses only physical data.
- 14 **Why may different future scenarios appear in climate models?**
- A Temperature records automatically determine which scenario is correct.
 - B Clouds directly create the greenhouse gas emissions used in each scenario.
 - C The outcomes depend on factors such as human activity and emissions.
 - D Supercomputers reduce global warming whenever they process more data.
- 15 **Which description best captures the contrasting effects of clouds?**
- A They cool the planet by blocking sunlight but have no warming effect.
 - B They block sunlight to cool the planet and trap heat to warm it.
 - C They admit sunlight to warm the planet and trap heat to cool it.
 - D They affect climate only because they are always moving and changing.
- 16 **What practical concern is raised about producing accurate projections?**
- A Models may be unable to use information collected outside the UK.
 - B Information from different countries will always contradict itself.
 - C Models may have to replace all direct observation of the climate.
 - D Supercomputers may require a very large amount of worldwide information.
- 17 **What position does the climate scientist take on further scientific work?**
- A It remains essential because completely avoiding climate change is no longer an available option.
 - B It should stop until climate models can remove every uncertainty.
 - C It is useful only if it can prevent all climate change.
 - D It becomes unnecessary once societies begin to adapt.
- 18 **What can be inferred from the discussion of adaptation and complex models?**
- A Societies should delay planning until models provide exact predictions.
 - B Models should leave human activity out to become easier to understand.
 - C Imperfect guidance can still help societies prepare for unavoidable change.
 - D Adaptation is needed because scientific research causes climate change.

- 19 **What is the function of the final statement about humans causing global warming?**
- A To prove that every climate projection will definitely occur
 - B To show that the effects of clouds no longer need to be studied
 - C To shift responsibility for climate change from people to models
 - D To connect human responsibility for the problem with the ability to address it
- 20 **What overall implication does the discussion offer about responding to global warming?**
- A Climate science is useful only when it produces completely certain forecasts.
 - B Human action remains central because people helped create the problem and can influence the solution.
 - C Uncertainty about clouds prevents people from making meaningful climate decisions.
 - D Continued warming makes both mitigation and adaptation pointless.